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While Paris is always special, this summer it's going to be particularly remarkable as it plays host to the XXXIII Olympic Games, 100 years after it last did so in 1924. More than 15 million visitors are expected to visit the city during the Games from July 26 to August 11, and then from August 28 to September 8 for the Paralympics. If you have tickets for some of the sporting events or if you are planning a trip to the French capital during the summer, here's our pick of activities for you to indulge in.

## WATCH THE OPENING CEREMONY

The French love doing things differently, and with the world's eyes on them, what better way to make a statement than by hosting a groundbreaking opening ceremony on the Seine! For the first time in modern Olympic history, the ceremony won't take place in a stadium but on the Seine itself, with delegates parading on more than 80 boats. The ceremony will drift slowly from east to west, bridge to bridge, snaking 6 km from Pont d'Austerlitz to Pont d'Iéna. Not only will this be spectacular, but also make it more accessible to the general public (read you). Although the lower stands are exclusively for ticket



**GAME SHOW** Visit 'Olympism—Modern Invention, Ancient Legacy', a special exhibition at the Louvre that is on till September 16, on the creation of the first modern Olympic Games

holders, the upper stands are open to the general public. So, pack your picnic basket and go early to grab the best spot. And even if you don't get a seat, fear not; big screens will also be set up all along the river, so you won't miss any of the action.

## HEAD TO THE FAN ZONES

If you weren't lucky enough to obtain tickets to your favourite Olympic events, don't worry! As many as 25 fan zones, with a capacity of 5,000 each, will be set up across the city where you can enjoy the Games on the big screen with other people who share your enthusiasm. These will also have food and drink stalls. Of course, they will be busy, but the vibe will be immaculate, with everyone cheering for their countries in a total melting pot of cultures. If you wish to see any of the athletes, then head to Place du Trocadéro, which will host the 'Champions Park', to celebrate the new champions of that day, who will parade with their medals.



**IN HIGH SPIRITS** French food and wine are enough to warrant a trip there. But, book in advance, as a lot of people visiting the city will have them on their minds and itineraries